began again with issue #76, now boasting the phrase "Captain America, Commie Smasher" on each cover. However, America had changed and seemingly outgrown such blatant propaganda. Captain America was soon put on ice once more, until famous comic-book writer/editor Stan Lee took it upon himself to thaw out the old icon.

Ignoring the hero's Cold War adventures, Lee and Cap co-creator Jack Kirby resurrected him into their popular super-hero team book *Avengers* in March 1964 with the conceit that the other Avengers had discovered the World War II icon frozen in an iceberg. Instead of using the hero to coax troops into Vietnam or in support of any other war effort, Lee instead decided to play Cap as a man out of time, wondering what his place was in the brave new world into which he'd been reborn. By questioning his own government and its agenda, Captain America again captured the public sentiment, suddenly becoming just as relevant as he'd been decades earlier.

And it was this reinvention that would keep the hero a Marvel mainstay in the years to come. During the 1970s, he teamed up with African-American hero the Falcon. In the 1980s and 1990s, he found himself at odds with his own government and even abandoned his super-hero identity for a time in favor of a new one: the Captain. In addition to confronting corrupt factions of the government, he faced a more violent version of his crime-fighting persona in the form of the volatile USAgent, outfitted in the uniform Steve Rogers had worn as the Captain.

But it was in September of 2001 that Captain America would truly return to his roots. When terrorists attacked and destroyed the World Trade Center in New York City, the country needed a patriot more than ever. Out of this unified desire for justice came a new *Captain America* series in

